



Accounting for Reconciliation

Reflect

- Whitney describes the many ways she has used the word “reconciliation” throughout her life. In what contexts have you heard the word “reconciliation” used? What does it bring to mind for you?
- The idea of reconciliation was created by Luca Pacioli as a method of financial accounting. Is this context surprising to you? How does it affect your understanding of the term “reconciliation”?
- What language have you heard in relation to racial justice that is harmful? That is helpful? How important is the language we use when it comes to social justice activism?

Respond

- Whitney states “I am not proposing alternate language today, and I am not redeeming the word reconciliation.” What, instead, would you argue is the take-away of this talk? What should this talk inspire listeners to do?
- Whitney asks white listeners if their love for reconciliation language might have something to do with their whiteness. What do you think? Is “reconciliation” language particularly popular with white people? If you identify as Black, Indigenous, or a Person of Color, do you like the idea of reconciliation? Is there other language you prefer?